

The Assignment Operator in Svelte 3/4

Q27

STATE (LEGACY)

INTERVIEW QUESTION

Question. What is the operational significance of the assignment operator (=) in Svelte 3/4 reactivity?

ANSWER. The assignment operator (=) is the fundamental trigger for reactivity. The compiler detects assignments to top-level variables and explicitly injects an internal `$$invalidate` function call to queue a DOM update. Mutating data via internal methods like `push()` without reassignment bypasses this detection.

App.svelte

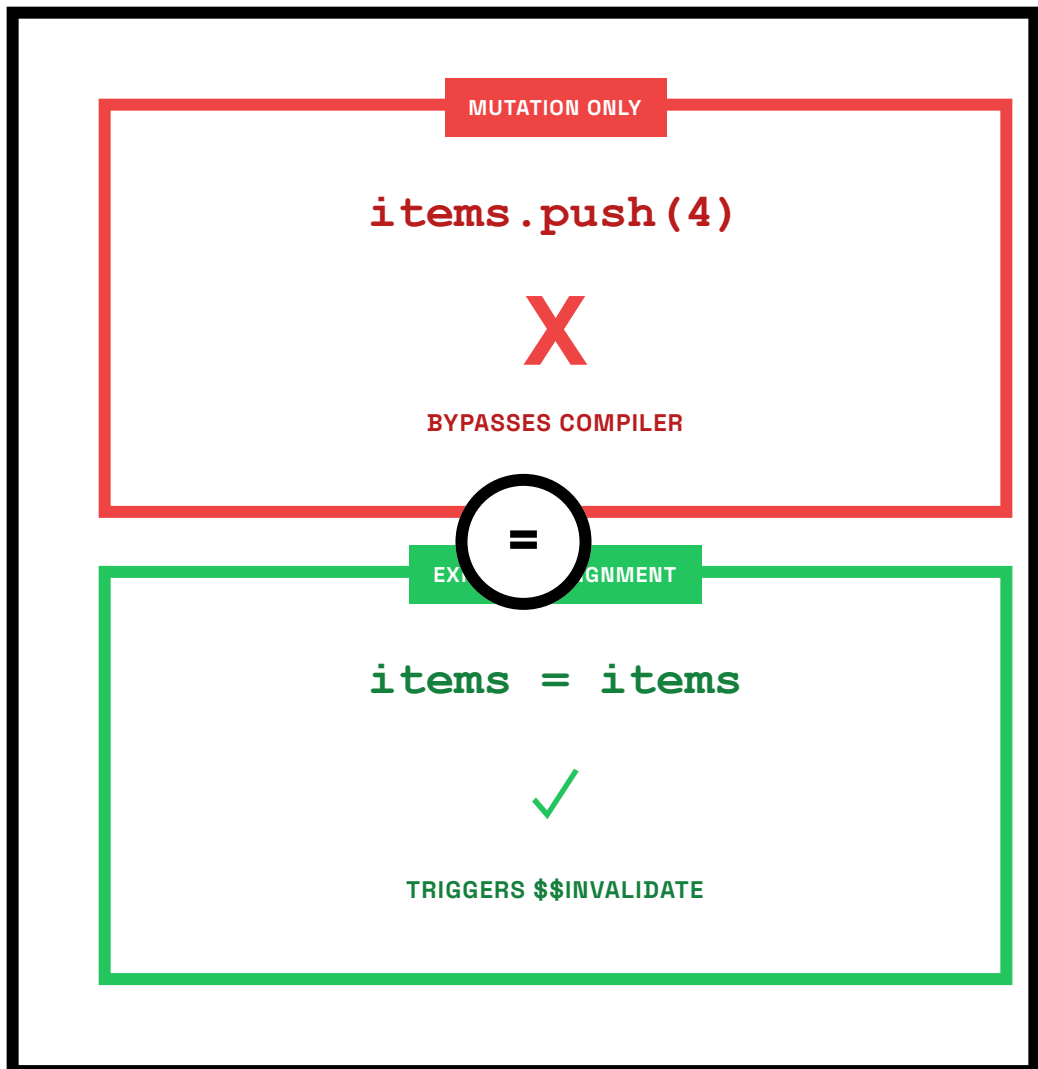
```
<script>
  let items = [1, 2, 3];

  function addItem() {
    // A method mutation alone does NOT trigger reactivity
    items.push(4);

    // The assignment operator (=) signals the compiler to
    update the DOM
    items = items;
  }
</script>

<ul>
  {#each items as item}
    <li>{item}</li>
```

```
{/each}  
</ul>
```



- ① **Summary.** Mutating an array or object in Svelte 3 and 4 is not enough. You must follow any mutation with an explicit assignment to trigger the compiler's reactivity tracking and update the DOM.